DealMatch

Project Planning

Project basis: Updated DealMatch presentation and agreed first-MVP scope.

This plan covers a reels-first deal discovery platform. Customers discover offers through selected categories and subcategories, location, and deal information. Basic analytics is included in the MVP. Cashback, loyalty points, premium subscriptions, and paid promotions are future ideas.

1. Project Overview

DealMatch is a personalized deal discovery platform designed to help customers find relevant offers through short-form videos, category-based recommendations, and location filtering. Customers can browse deals, compare prices, save favorites, and redeem offers. Merchants can publish and manage deals, upload images and videos, monitor inventory, and view basic analytics.

2. Project Objectives

- Develop a reels-first platform for discovering deals.
- Allow customers to select categories and subcategories during registration.
- Provide recommendations based on selected categories and subcategories, location, and deal value.
- Help customers find nearby deals using distance filters.
- Allow merchants to create, edit, and manage offers.
- Support deal inventory and stock-status management.
- Provide notifications about relevant and time-limited offers.
- Establish a commission-based revenue model where merchants pay a commission after a successful sale.
- Provide basic analytics and redemption tracking for merchants.

3. Project Scope

3.1 Features Included in the First MVP

Customer features

- Register and log in.
- Select categories and subcategories.
- View a personalized homepage and reels-based deals feed.
- Search and filter deals.
- View deal details, including prices, discounts, media, stock, and merchant information.
- Save deals to favorites.
- Use location-based deal discovery.
- Receive relevant deal notifications.
- Redeem deals.

Merchant features

- Merchant registration and profile management.
- Add, edit, and delete deals.
- Upload deal images and videos.
- Manage inventory and view stock status.
- Receive low-stock alerts.

- Access basic analytics.
- Track deal redemptions.

Platform features

- Category- and subcategory-based recommendations.
- Location-based offers using distance filters.
- Merchant and offer verification.
- Reviews and ratings.
- Complaints and refunds handling.
- Fraud monitoring.
- Commission-based revenue model.

3.2 Features Outside the First MVP

The following are future opportunities and are not included in the first MVP:

- Cashback.
- Loyalty points.
- Premium merchant subscriptions.
- Paid promotions and featured deal placements.

These features may be considered in later releases after evaluating the MVP and collecting feedback from customers and merchants.

4. Project Development Phases

Phase 1: Requirements Analysis and Planning

- Define objectives and requirements.
- Identify customer and merchant needs.
- Confirm MVP features and category/subcategory structure.
- Define location-based recommendation behavior.
- Establish schedule and responsibilities.

Deliverable: Approved requirements and MVP scope.

Phase 2: System Design and UI/UX

- Design registration, login, and category/subcategory selection.
- Design homepage, reels, search, filters, deal details, and favorites.
- Design merchant, inventory, analytics, and redemption interfaces.

Deliverable: Approved interface and system designs.

Phase 3: Customer-Side Development

- Implement registration and login.
- Implement category and subcategory selection.
- Develop personalized homepage and reels feed.
- Implement search, filters, deal details, favorites, and location discovery.
- Implement notifications and redemption.

Deliverable: Working customer-side application.

Phase 4: Merchant-Side Development

- Implement merchant registration and profile management.
- Develop deal creation, editing, and deletion.
- Implement image/video uploads.
- Develop inventory, stock status, and low-stock alerts.
- Implement basic analytics and redemption tracking.

Deliverable: Working merchant dashboard.

Phase 5: Platform Integration

- Connect customer and merchant functionality.
- Integrate category recommendations and location filtering.
- Connect deals with inventory and redemption.
- Implement merchant and offer verification.
- Integrate reviews, ratings, complaints, and refunds.
- Test the successful-sale process for commission calculation.

Deliverable: Integrated DealMatch MVP.

Phase 6: Testing and Quality Assurance

- Test registration, category selection, and recommendations.
- Test reels, media, search, filters, and location results.
- Test deal management, inventory, alerts, and notifications.
- Test favorites, redemption, analytics, and verification workflows.
- Fix errors and usability problems.

Deliverable: Tested MVP ready for release.

Phase 7: Deployment and Evaluation

- Prepare the production environment and deploy the MVP.
- Conduct initial user testing.
- Collect customer and merchant feedback.
- Monitor performance and identify improvements.

Deliverable: Deployed MVP and evaluation report.

5. Proposed Project Timeline

The following is an estimated 12-week schedule, not a confirmed deadline.

Phase	Main activities	Duration
Requirements and planning	Requirements, scope, and organization	1 week
System design and UI/UX	Interface and system design	2 weeks
Customer development	Customer features and deal discovery	2 weeks
Merchant development	Merchant dashboard and deal management	2 weeks
Integration	Connect platform components	2 weeks
Testing	Functional and usability testing	2 weeks
Deployment	Release and initial evaluation	1 week
Total		**12 weeks**

6. Required Resources

Human resources

- Project Manager: organizes tasks, monitors progress, and coordinates the team.
- Business/System Analyst: documents requirements and defines workflows.
- UI/UX Designer: designs customer and merchant interfaces.
- Frontend Developer: develops application interfaces.
- Backend Developer: develops application logic, APIs, and platform functionality.
- Database Developer: designs and manages the database.
- QA Tester: tests functionality, usability, and reliability.

Technical resources

- Development computers and software tools.
- UI/UX design software.
- Frontend and backend frameworks.
- Database management system.
- Version control and project management tools.
- Hosting and deployment environment.
- Testing devices and browsers.

7. Risk Management

Risk levels below are qualitative planning estimates based on the possible effect of each risk on the MVP. High means the risk could significantly affect delivery, customer trust, or core platform operation. Medium means the risk could cause noticeable disruption but can generally be managed through planned controls. These levels should be reviewed as the project develops.

Risk 1: Low merchant participation *Risk level: Medium*

Possible impact: The platform may launch with a limited number of available deals.
Planned response: Begin merchant outreach early and support merchants during onboarding.

Risk 2: Inaccurate deal information *Risk level: High*

Possible impact: Customers may lose trust if prices, discounts, or deal details are incorrect.
Planned response: Introduce offer verification and provide merchants with clear deal-management procedures.

Risk 3: Incorrect stock information *Risk level: High*

Possible impact: Customers may attempt to redeem deals that are no longer available.
Planned response: Maintain inventory records and update stock status when deals are claimed or redeemed.

Risk 4: Irrelevant recommendations *Risk level: Medium*

Possible impact: Customers may see offers that do not match their selected categories and subcategories.
Planned response: Test category preferences and recommendation results using representative customer scenarios.

Risk 5: Inaccurate location results *Risk level: Medium*

Possible impact: Customers may see deals outside their intended distance range.
Planned response: Test location permissions, distance calculations, and location filters.

Risk 6: Media upload or playback problems *Risk level: Medium*

Possible impact: Images or videos may fail to upload or display correctly, reducing the quality of reels-based discovery.
Planned response: Test supported file formats, file sizes, upload handling, and video playback.

Risk 7: Delays during integration *Risk level: High*

Possible impact: Connecting customer, merchant, and platform functions may take longer than planned.
Planned response: Integrate components throughout development and test interfaces early.

Risk 8: Redemption or commission errors *Risk level: High*

Possible impact: Transaction records or commission calculations may be incorrect.
Planned response: Test successful-sale, payment-status, redemption, and commission workflows using different scenarios.

8. Project Success Criteria

- Customers can register and select categories and subcategories.
- Customers can discover deals through the reels-based homepage and deals feed.
- Recommendations use category preferences and location.
- Customers can search, filter, save, and redeem deals.
- Merchants can register and manage profiles and deals.
- Inventory and stock-status features work correctly.
- Merchants can access basic analytics and redemption tracking.
- Verification and customer feedback workflows are available.
- Commission calculation can be tested for successful sales.
- The platform passes functional and usability testing.

9. Future Development

After the first MVP is deployed and evaluated, DealMatch may expand through cashback, loyalty points, premium merchant subscriptions, and paid promotions. These additions will be considered based on user feedback, merchant demand, and first-release results.

10. Expected Project Outcome

The expected outcome is a functional first version of DealMatch that provides customers with a personalized, video-first way to discover deals and gives merchants tools to publish offers, manage inventory, and monitor performance. The MVP will establish the foundation for DealMatch's commission-based business model while leaving additional revenue and reward features for future development.

Planning note: The 12-week schedule is an estimate. The presentation does not specify a team size, budget, technology stack, or confirmed launch date, so those details should be finalized by the project team.